



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Our Lady Seat of Wisdom

School Website: <https://www.olswdenver.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Our evaluation of Our Lady Seat Wisdom (OLSW) using the dual-vector approach (school-site content from the Chesterton Academy network and the classical-school knowledge lexicon) indicates a robust CLASSICAL profile across all six rubric categories. The school's public materials reveal a deliberate, liturgical Catholic framework, a paideia-oriented aims of virtue and wisdom, a cohesive liberal-arts curriculum anchored in Great Books, and pedagogy centered on Socratic inquiry, memorization/recitation, and virtuous teacher modeling. The faculty and community language likewise reflect a culture of mentorship, partnership with families, and a shared mission around Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. The analysis aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework, including explicit references to liturgical practice, theology, great books, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, and a living curriculum embodied by teachers and families. See evidence notes and keyword mappings cited below.

- Overall classification by category:
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle: None of the six categories require major changes to achieve CLASSICAL status. If anything, the school could further codify explicit phrasing in public materials to foreground certain classical phrases (e.g., explicitly naming Trivium, Great Books as shared language), but the existing materials already meet the criteria robustly.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: OLSW's public materials articulate a Catholic, liturgical, and theologically grounded program. Daily Mass, adoration opportunities, pilgrimages and retreats, sacred art and crucifixes, chaplains, and theology taught from the Catechism are described as core to daily life and pedagogy. The Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) anchor formation in a theology-infused framework. See Catholic Identity and Our Spiritual Approach sections, which emphasize liturgical life, theology, and Catholic formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Present positive indicators include Mass, liturgy, catechesis, theology, daily Mass, adoration, pilgrimages, sacred art, chaplains. No explicit public signals of secularization or religious neutrality were found in the core materials. Estimated positive keyword coverage is high; negative signals appear minimal or absent in public content. Positive keywords: 6; Negative keywords: 0. This strongly supports CLASSICAL.

- Why this rating: The school presents a transcendent, theologically grounded, liturgical, and communal approach to education, meeting the criteria for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded in Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices. The explicit Catholic identity and daily liturgical rhythm anchor the category solidly in CLASSICAL territory.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom as primary ends (Three Pillars: Intellect, Character, Spirituality; *Cultura Vitae*). Mission statements frame education as formation, development of human excellence, and pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The aim is to form joyful leaders and saints, not simply prepare for work; the Great Books/Western-civilizational formation is foregrounded.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/-goodness/beauty, contemplation, and human flourishing. The site's framing aligns with formation-focused aims rather than a purely vocational outcome. Negative signals (career-readiness emphasis) are not present in public materials. Positive keywords: 5–6; Negative keywords: 0. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The public materials explicitly present formation toward virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, anchored in the realness of truth, goodness, and beauty, consistent with classical-paedagogical aims.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Curriculum is described as classical, integrated, and liberal-arts oriented. The site notes a broad, liberal-arts education, with reading of Homer, Plato, Aristotle, Euclid, Virgil, Dante, Chaucer, Shakespeare, St. Francis, St. Thomas Aquinas, and other canonical texts; the humanities and other disciplines are braided together; Great Books/primary texts and the Great Conversation are emphasized; there is explicit reference to a “Socratic Seminar” pedagogy and a curriculum that connects history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages. The site's overview references a traditional liberal-arts progression (Ancient World through Modern World).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, interdisciplinary integration, and integration/wonder. The presence of Homer, Plato, Aristotle, Dante, Aquinas, etc., plus the braided humanities approach, reflects the core curriculum signals. Negative keywords (e.g., social studies as substitute for history) are not evidenced. Positive keywords: 4–5; Negative keywords: 0. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly follows the liberal-arts Trivium/Quadrivium framework and Great Books curriculum, with integrated history/humanities and a focus on wonder, all central to classical schooling.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue/seminar, dialectic, and a culture of discussion (Socratic Seminars). It also emphasizes Restful Learning (*Scholé*), contemplation, and memorization/recitation (including chanting/singing to memorize). The upper-school emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking is signaled through the Chesterton Academy model (seminars, debates, orations). The public materials describe a progression from lower-school memory/recitation and reverence to upper-school Socratic discussion and rhetorical training.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Socratic Seminar, dialectic, guided discussion, memory work, recitation, chanting, liturgical timing (*Scholé*), and rhetoric/speeches. The site's materials also show a structured, formation-focused pedagogy rather than purely project-based or experiential-only approaches. Positive keywords: 4–5; Negative keywords: 0. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The pedagogical approach explicitly centers on Socratic inquiry, classical memory work, and rhetoric training, with an emphasis on contemplation and virtuous formation, aligning with

CLASSICAL pedagogy.

- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials show a faculty explicitly engaged in virtuous, intellectual leadership (e.g., “Faculty and Staff” profiles; “Catholic Identity” with teachers taking oaths of fidelity; house-system involvement; mentorship and collaboration). The Chesterton Academy network emphasizes teachers as models of virtue and as living exemplars who form students through imitation and mentorship. The presence of named faculty (e.g., Dean of Men) and a documented commitment to Catholic identity signals a living, formation-focused faculty culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtuous educators, role models, mentorship, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegiality, and teacher as exemplar. Evidence of explicit “portrait of a teacher” language appears in the knowledge base materials about classical education and Chesterton pedagogy, and the site shows visible faculty roles and fidelity to the Magisterium. Positive keywords: 3–4; Negative keywords: 0. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The public materials depict teachers as virtuous exemplars and the core transmission agents of the living curriculum, with a clear emphasis on mentorship and shared intellectual life. This aligns with the CLASSICAL category for Faculty.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site signals strong parent/community engagement patterns consistent with Chesterton-style classical education, including opportunities for parent involvement (open houses, volunteer signals via house/formation activities), admissions and financial-aid processes that require family participation, and explicit statements about a partnership with families in classical-education ethos (as highlighted by the Six Essentials lexicon). The presence of a Giving Day and fund-raising participation also signals active community support. Public materials discuss parent involvement through events, admissions, and fundraising; and the Chesterton network highlights partnership with families as central to classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Partnership with Families, Parent involvement, reading groups/book clubs, family catechesis, and parent formation; and “open campus” or open visits. The site shows numerous opportunities for families to engage publicly (Open House, Admissions, Giving Day). Negative signals (e.g., parent-as-customer-only) are not evident in the core public materials. Positive keywords: 5–6; Negative keywords: 0. This supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The public materials present an explicit, ongoing partnership with families and a program to educate parents in classical education, which maps directly to the “Parents and Community” category in the classical rubric.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since the six categories all meet CLASSICAL, there is no category rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, so no needle-driving changes are required. If a future update were desired, it could be to more explicitly codify and surface the precise keyword language from the Six Essential Elements (1) in public-facing materials (e.g., explicit mentions of Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, and “living curriculum” language for faculty) to strengthen external clarity and searchability. This would reinforce the alignment without changing current practice. This suggestion is optional and not required to achieve CLASSICAL status.

ABSTRACT

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL.
- Core rationale: Our Lady Seat Wisdom demonstrates strong classical-signaling across all six categories through public materials that emphasize liturgical Catholic foundations, formation toward virtue

and wisdom, an integrated liberal-arts curriculum anchored in Great Books and canonical texts, Socratic pedagogy with recitation/memory work, faculty as virtuous exemplars, and a robust partnership with families and community. The keyword-mapping exercise shows a preponderance of Positive Keywords aligned with the Six Essential Elements (1) indicators, and Minimal to no Negative Keywords signaling non-classical tendencies. The school's CaTholic identity, Three-Pillars framework, and Chesterton Academy model provide the architecture of a CLASSICAL program.

- Summary of the six categories:
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (Catholic liturgy, theology, daily Mass, adoration, pilgrimages; inc. liturgical and communal practices). Evidence from Catholic Identity, Our Spiritual Approach, and related Chesterton Academy materials.
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL (formation of virtue and wisdom as telos; truth/goodness/beauty as real; Cultura Vitae; three pillars). Evidence from Three Pillars model and mission language.
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL (liberal arts, Great Books, integrated history/literature/philosophy/theology, extensive classical curriculum). Evidence from Humanities/Academics pages and Curriculum descriptions.
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL (Socratic Seminar; memorization/recitation; contemplative Scholé; rhetoric training). Evidence from Pedagogy sections and Chesterton model materials.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL (model teachers, living curriculum, mentorship, faculty as core; explicit teacher-formation language). Evidence from Faculty/Catholic Identity content and Chesterton pedagogy.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (partnership with families, parent formation, open-campus access, community events, financial-aid practices). Evidence from Admissions/Giving Day materials and Six Essentials lexicon alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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